application teams no longer needed to create their own versions of these controls. They could focus on domain logic—what their service should allow—while trusting other policy layers to handle posture checks, authentication strength, and operational constraints.

This separation of concerns made the authorization model more flexible. As the security team introduced new foundational requirements, applications automatically adopted them without needing code changes or redeployments. Conversely, when product teams added new actions or resources, those updates integrated smoothly into the policy structure without reopening security reviews or refactoring authentication flows. PBAC became shared authorization infrastructure, providing developers with a stable platform to build on.

15.6.4 Improved governance and transparency

As ACME's policy ecosystem matured, governance became more organized and transparent. The security and identity teams handled core policies; operations groups took charge of shared ones; product teams set application policies. This clear division of responsibilities made policy review more predictable, enabled delegated accountability, and created a more open approval process.

Perhaps most importantly, the policy architecture made governance practical. Instead of treating governance as just a documentation task, the organization conveyed governance directly through executable policy. The rules that defined how ACME wanted to operate were the same rules enforced at runtime.

15.6.5 A more resilient security posture

Finally, Zero Trust made ACME more resilient. Because authorization decisions no longer depended on network boundaries or implicit trust, the company's exposure to lateral movement, credential misuse, and device compromise decreased. Strong authentication became standard; device posture signals became a regular part of decision-making; and contextual conditions prevented routine access from turning into high-risk access.